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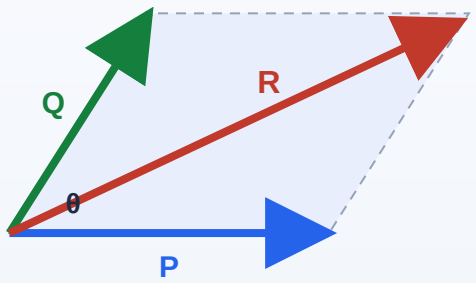
UPSSSC JE

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING MECHANICS

Complete English Edition

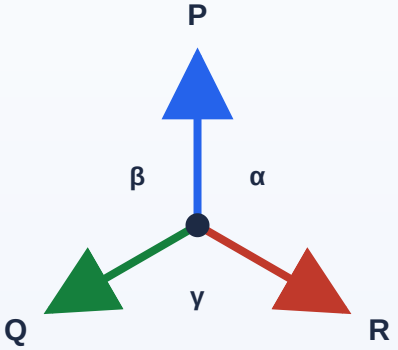
Unit 2 · 10 Marks · 2026

Parallelogram Law



$R = \sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2 + 2PQ \cos \theta)}$

Lami's Theorem



$P/\sin \alpha = Q/\sin \beta = R/\sin \gamma$

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UPSSSC JE (Mechanical) 2026: Part-1 has **10 questions (10 marks)** from **Engineering Mechanics**. Syllabus: equilibrium of forces, laws of motion and friction. This PDF follows every point of the official syllabus (Advertisement No. 24-Exam/2026).

Each chapter contains key points, diagrams, a formula table, detailed explanation, solved numericals, one-liners, MCQs with explanations and SSC JE previous year questions. Content follows standard BTEUP diploma textbooks (R. S. Khurmi, R. K. Bansal).

For a better score, study this PDF and also attempt the QUIZ.

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Chapter 1: Equilibrium of Forces

Equilibrium of Forces – Basic Concept

Force is an external agent that changes or tends to change the state of rest or motion of a body. Force is a **vector quantity**; its magnitude, direction, point of application and line of action must all be known. When the resultant of all forces acting on a body is zero and there is no turning effect, the body is said to be in **equilibrium**.

1. Key Points

- **Unit of force:** newton (N) in SI; 1 N = 1 kg·m/s². 1 kgf = 9.81 N and 1 dyne = 10^{-5} N.
- **Types of force systems:** collinear (same line of action), concurrent (passing through one point), parallel, and non-concurrent non-parallel.
- **Parallelogram law of forces:** $R = \sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2 + 2PQ\cos\theta)}$ and $\tan\alpha = Q\sin\theta/(P + Q\cos\theta)$. At $\theta = 0°$, $R = P + Q$ (maximum); at $\theta = 180°$, $R = P - Q$ (minimum).
- **Conditions of equilibrium (coplanar forces):** $\Sigma Fx = 0$, $\Sigma Fy = 0$ and $\Sigma M = 0$. For concurrent forces only the first two are needed.
- **Lami's theorem:** if three concurrent forces are in equilibrium, each force is proportional to the sine of the angle between the other two: $P/\sin\alpha = Q/\sin\beta = R/\sin\gamma$.
- **Moment of a force:** M = F × perpendicular distance. Unit N·m. Clockwise and anticlockwise moments are taken with opposite signs.
- **Varignon's theorem:** the algebraic sum of moments of forces about a point equals the moment of their resultant about the same point.
- **Couple:** two equal, opposite, parallel forces with different lines of action. Moment of couple = F × arm; it is the same about every point and its resultant force is zero.
- **Free body diagram (FBD):** a sketch of the body isolated from its supports, showing all forces and reactions acting on it.

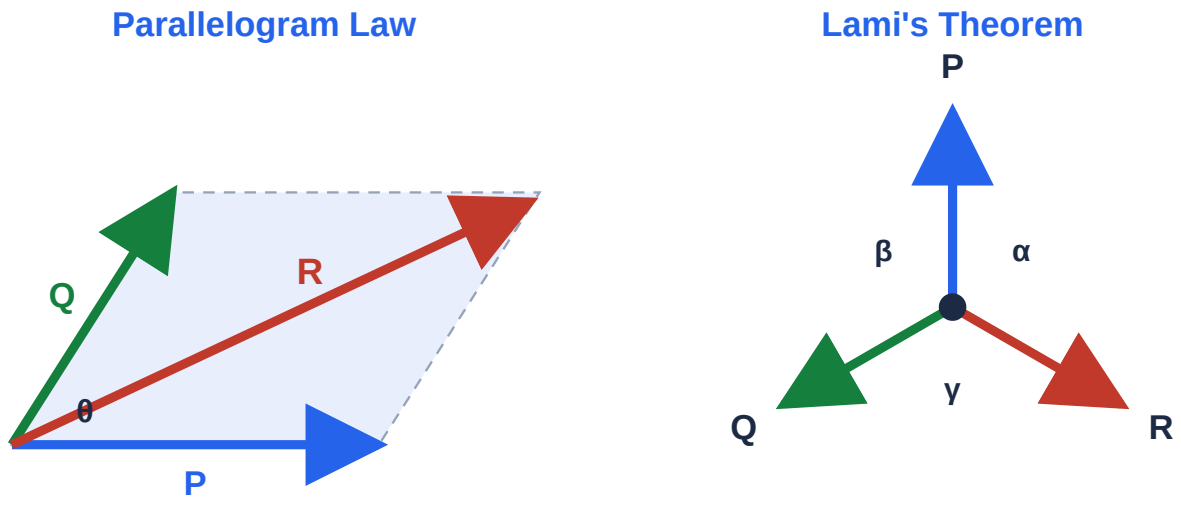


Fig 2.1: Parallelogram law of forces and Lami's theorem

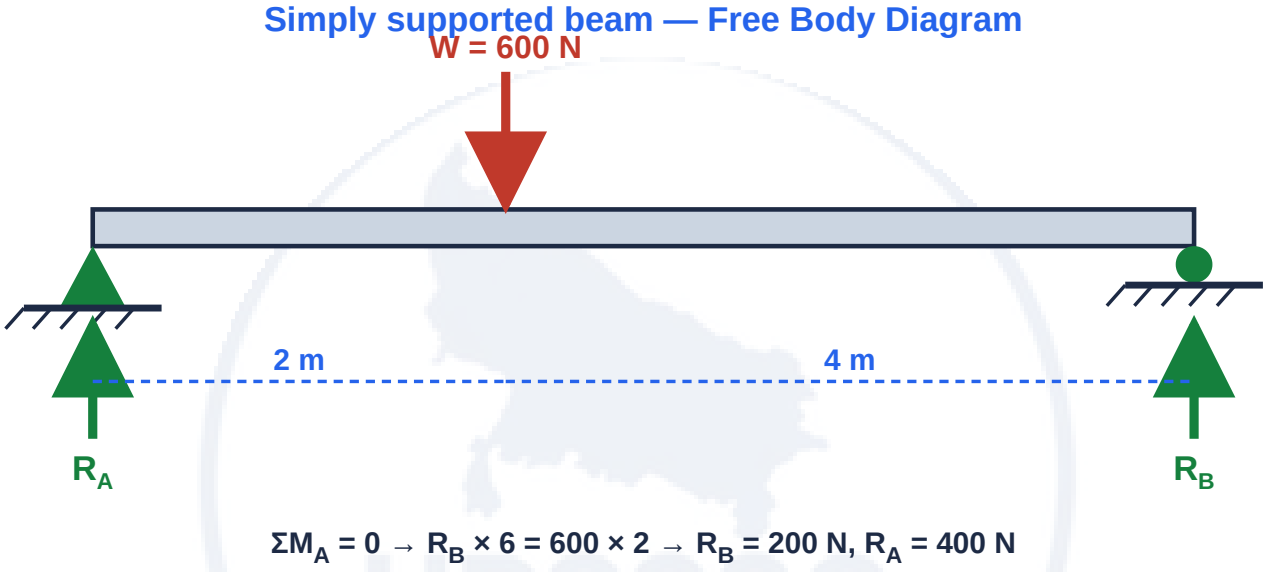


Fig 2.2: Support reactions by principle of moments

2. Important Formulas & Facts

Quantity / Topic	Formula / Fact
Resultant of two forces	$R = \sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2 + 2PQ\cos\theta)}$
Direction of resultant	$\tan\alpha = Q\sin\theta / (P + Q\cos\theta)$
Forces at right angle ($\theta = 90°$)	$R = \sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2)}$
Resolution of a force	$Fx = F\cos\theta$, $Fy = F\sin\theta$
Resultant of several forces	$R = \sqrt{[(\Sigma Fx)^2 + (\Sigma Fy)^2]}$, $\tan\alpha = \Sigma Fy/\Sigma Fx$
Lami's theorem	$P/\sin\alpha = Q/\sin\beta = R/\sin\gamma$
Moment	$M = F \times d$
Moment of a couple	$M = F \times a$ (a = भुजा / arm)

3. Detailed Explanation

- **Principle of transmissibility:** the point of application of a force on a rigid body may be moved anywhere along its line of action without changing its external effect.
- **Triangle law of forces:** if three forces represented in order by the sides of a triangle form a closed triangle, they are in equilibrium. The polygon law is its extension.
- **Equilibrium of two forces:** two forces are in equilibrium only if they are equal, opposite and collinear. For three forces in equilibrium they must be concurrent or parallel.
- **Supports and reactions:** a roller support gives one reaction normal to the surface; a hinge gives two components; a fixed support gives two forces and a moment.
- **Effect of a couple:** a couple produces only rotation, not translation. Shifting a force to another point gives a force plus a couple.

4. Comparison Table — Force vs Couple

Basis	Force	Couple
Effect	Translation (and rotation)	Rotation only
Resultant force	Not zero	Zero
Moment	Depends on the point	Same about all points
Balanced by	An equal opposite force	Only an opposite couple

5. Solved Numerical Problems

Example 1. Two forces of 30 N and 40 N act at a point at 90°. Find the magnitude and direction of the resultant.

Solution:

1. $R = \sqrt{(30^2 + 40^2)} = \sqrt{2500} =$ **50 N**
2. $\tan \alpha = 40/30 = 1.333$, so $\alpha =$ **53.13°** (from the 30 N force)

Example 2. Two equal forces P act at 120°. Find the resultant.

Solution:

1. $R = \sqrt{(P^2 + P^2 + 2P^2 \cos 120°)} = \sqrt{(2P^2 - P^2)}$
2. R = **P** (resultant equals each force)

Example 3. A 6 m simply supported beam carries 600 N at 2 m from end A. Find the reactions.

Solution:

1. Moments about A: $R_B \times 6 = 600 \times 2$, so $R_B =$ **200 N**
2. $R_A = 600 - 200 =$ **400 N**

Example 4. A 100 N weight hangs from two strings inclined at 30° and 60° to the vertical. Find the tensions.

Solution:

1. Angle between strings = 90°; between T_1 (30° string) and weight 150°, between T_2 and weight 120°
2. Lami: $T_1/\sin 120° = T_2/\sin 150° = 100/\sin 90°$
3. $T_1 = 100 \times 0.866 =$ **86.6 N**, $T_2 = 100 \times 0.5 =$ **50 N**

6. Frequently Asked Facts

- Lami's theorem applies only to three concurrent forces in equilibrium.
- A couple has zero resultant force but a non-zero moment.
- The resultant of two equal forces equals each force when the angle between them is 120°.

7. Note (Confusing Facts)

- Force and moment are vectors, but work and energy are scalars.
- At $\theta = 90°$ the resultant is $\sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2)}$, not P + Q.
- A couple cannot be balanced by a single force.

Remember: One line: for equilibrium $\Sigma Fx = \Sigma Fy = \Sigma M = 0$. Assertion–Reason: (A) A couple only rotates a body. (R) Its resultant force is zero. — Both true; R explains A.

20 Most Important One-Liner Facts — Equilibrium of Forces

1. SI unit of force?

— Newton (N).

2. 1 kgf equals?

— 9.81 N.

3. Force is which type of quantity?

— Vector.

4. Forces on the same line of action?

— Collinear forces.

5. Forces passing through one point?

— Concurrent forces.

6. Maximum resultant of two forces?

— P + Q ($\theta = 0°$).

7. Minimum resultant of two forces?

— P − Q ($\theta = 180°$).

8. Resultant of two forces at 90°?

— $\sqrt{(P^2 + Q^2)}$.

9. Lami's theorem applies to how many forces?

— Three concurrent forces.

10. Unit of moment?

— N·m.

11. Principle of moments is due to?

— Varignon.

12. Resultant force of a couple?

— Zero.

13. Effect of a couple?

— Rotation only.

14. Principle of transmissibility?

— Force may be moved along its line of action.

15. Reactions at a roller support?

— One (normal to surface).

16. Reactions at a hinge?

— Two components.

17. Reactions at a fixed support?

— Two forces + one moment.

18. When are two forces in equilibrium?

— Equal, opposite and collinear.

19. A closed force triangle means?

— Forces are in equilibrium.

20. Resolution of a force?

— F cos θ and F sin θ.

Practice MCQs — Equilibrium of Forces

Q1. The resultant of two equal forces equals either force. The angle between them is:

(a) 60°
(b) 90°
(c) 120°
(d) 180°

✔ **Answer: (c) 120°**

Explanation: $R^2 = 2P^2(1 + \cos\theta) = P^2$ gives $\cos\theta = -½$, $\theta = 120°$.

Q2. Lami's theorem applies to:

(a) Two forces
(b) Three concurrent forces
(c) Parallel forces
(d) Any number of forces

✔ **Answer: (b) Three concurrent forces**

Explanation: Only three concurrent forces in equilibrium.

Q3. The resultant force of a couple is:

(a) Zero
(b) Twice the force
(c) Equal to the force
(d) Infinite

✔ **Answer: (a) Zero**

Explanation: The two forces are equal and opposite.

Q4. Resultant of 30 N and 40 N at right angles is:

(a) 70 N
(b) 10 N
(c) 50 N
(d) 35 N

✔ **Answer: (c) 50 N**

Explanation: $\sqrt{(900 + 1600)} = 50$ N.

Q5. The principle of moments is known as:

(a) Lami's
(b) Varignon's
(c) Newton's
(d) D'Alembert's

✔ **Answer: (b) Varignon's**

Explanation: Varignon's theorem.

Q6. Number of unknown reactions at a fixed support:

(a) 1
(b) 2
(c) 3
(d) 4

✔ **Answer: (c) 3**

Explanation: Two force components and one moment.

Q7. Conditions needed for equilibrium of concurrent forces:

(a) ΣFx = 0 (b) ΣFy = 0

(c) ΣFx = 0 and ΣFy = 0 (d) ΣM = 0

✔ **Answer: (c) ΣFx = 0 and ΣFy = 0**

Explanation: For concurrent forces the moment is automatically zero.

Q8. Moving a force along its line of action does not change its effect — this is:

(a) Principle of transmissibility (b) Principle of superposition

(c) Lami's theorem (d) Triangle law

✔ **Answer: (a) Principle of transmissibility**

Explanation: Principle of transmissibility.

Q9. The resultant of two forces is maximum when the angle between them is:

(a) 0° (b) 90°

(c) 120° (d) 180°

✔ **Answer: (a) 0°**

Explanation: At θ = 0°, cos θ = 1 and R = P + Q.

Q10. 1 kgf equals:

(a) 1 N (b) 9.81 N

(c) 10^5 dyne (d) 0.981 N

✔ **Answer: (b) 9.81 N**

Explanation: 1 kgf = 1 kg × 9.81 m/s².

SSC JE / UPSSSC JE Previous Year Questions — Equilibrium of Forces

Q1. If three concurrent forces are in equilibrium, each is proportional to the ____ of the angle between the other two: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) sine (b) cosine

(c) tangent (d) cotangent

✔ **Answer: (a) sine**

Explanation: Lami's theorem.

Q2. Moment of a couple equals: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Force × arm (b) Force ÷ arm

(c) Force × velocity (d) Zero

✔ **Answer: (a) Force × arm**

Explanation: M = F × a.

Q3. Two forces of 5 N and 12 N act at right angles. The resultant is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) 17 N
(b) 7 N
(c) 13 N
(d) 60 N

✔ **Answer: (c) 13 N**

Explanation: √(25 + 144) = 13 N.

Q4. Reaction at a hinged support is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Only vertical
(b) Only horizontal
(c) Both vertical and horizontal
(d) A moment

✔ **Answer: (c) Both vertical and horizontal**

Explanation: A hinge gives two components, no moment.

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Chapter 2: Laws of Motion

Laws of Motion – Basic Concept

Dynamics studies the motion of bodies together with the forces causing it. Newton's three laws of motion form the foundation of mechanics, and quantities such as momentum, impulse, work, power and energy are built on them.

1. Key Points

- **Newton's first law (law of inertia):** a body continues in its state of rest or uniform motion unless an external force compels it to change. It gives the **definition of force** and of **inertia**.
- **Newton's second law:** the rate of change of momentum is proportional to the applied force and takes place in its direction: $F = dp/dt = m \cdot a$. It gives the **measurement of force**.
- **Newton's third law:** to every action there is an equal and opposite reaction. Action and reaction act on different bodies, so they do not cancel.
- **Momentum:** $p = m \cdot v$ (kg·m/s). **Impulse:** $J = F \cdot t = \Delta p$. If external force is zero, total momentum is conserved (rocket, recoil of gun).
- **Equations of motion (uniform acceleration):** $v = u + at$, $s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$, $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$. Distance in nth second $s_n = u + a(2n - 1)/2$.
- **D'Alembert's principle:** $F - ma = 0$; adding an inertia force $(-ma)$ turns a dynamic problem into one of static equilibrium.
- **Work, power, energy:** work $W = F \cdot s \cdot \cos\theta$ (J); power $P = W/t = F \cdot v$ (W); kinetic energy $\frac{1}{2}mv^2$, potential energy mgh. Work–energy theorem: net work = change in kinetic energy.
- **Apparent weight in a lift:** accelerating up $R = m(g + a)$; accelerating down $R = m(g - a)$; free fall $R = 0$ (weightlessness).
- **Collision:** coefficient of restitution $e = (v_2 - v_1)/(u_1 - u_2)$. Perfectly elastic $e = 1$; perfectly inelastic $e = 0$ (bodies stick together).

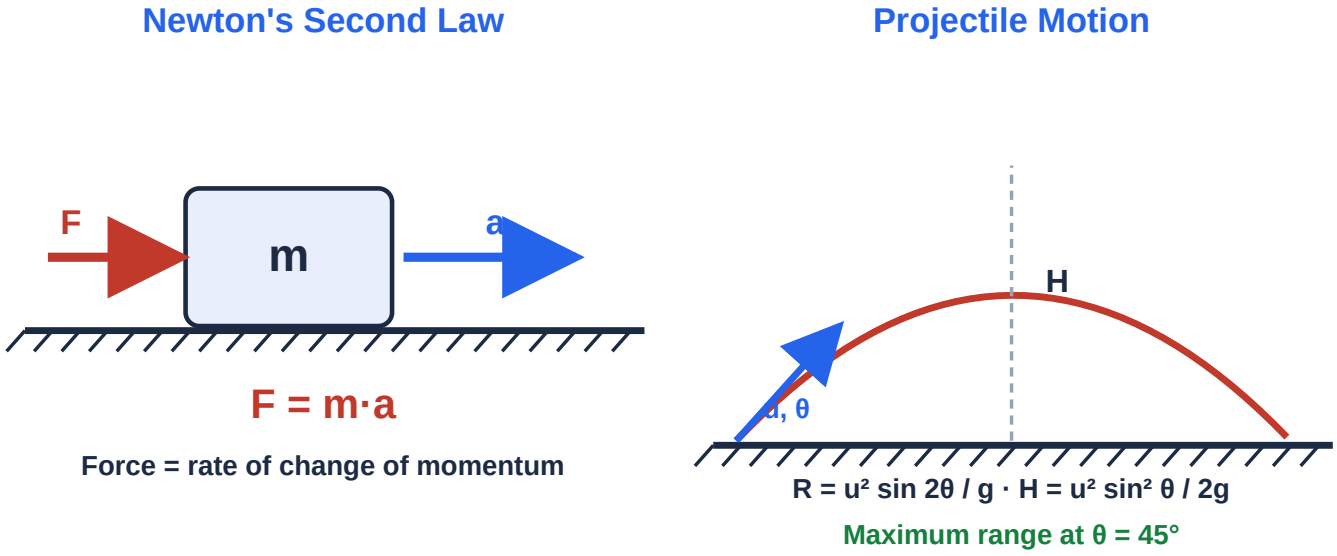


Fig 2.3: Newton's second law and path of a projectile

2. Important Formulas & Facts

Quantity / Topic	Formula / Fact
Second law	**$F = m{\cdot}a = dp/dt$**
Momentum / Impulse	**$p = mv$, $J = F{\cdot}t = \Delta p$**
Equations of motion	**$v = u + at$, $s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$, $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$**
Work	**$W = F\,s\cos\theta$**
Power	**$P = W/t = F{\cdot}v$**
Kinetic / Potential energy	**$\frac{1}{2}mv^2$, mgh**
Range of projectile	**$R = u^2 \sin 2\theta / g$ (अधिकतम $\theta = 45°$)**
Max height / Time of flight	**$H = u^2 \sin^2\theta / 2g$, $T = 2u \sin\theta / g$**
Circular motion	**$a = v^2/r$, $F = mv^2/r$**

3. Detailed Explanation

- **Inertia:** the property by which a body resists a change in its state. Mass is the measure of inertia — more mass, more inertia.
- **Examples of momentum conservation:** recoil of a gun when a bullet is fired: $m_g v_g = m_b v_b$; rocket propulsion works on the same principle.
- **Use of impulse:** pulling the hands back while catching a ball increases the time and reduces the force ($F = \Delta p/t$). Airbags and shock absorbers use the same idea.
- **Circular motion:** even at uniform speed in a circle there is a centripetal acceleration v^2/r towards the centre, requiring a centripetal force mv^2/r.
- **Projectile:** the horizontal velocity stays constant ($u\cos\theta$) and only g acts vertically. The range is the same for θ and $(90° - \theta)$.

4. Comparison Table — Mass vs Weight

Basis	Mass	Weight
Definition	Quantity of matter	Earth's pull (mg)
Quantity	Scalar	Vector
Unit	kg	N
Depends on place	No	Yes (on g)

5. Solved Numerical Problems

Example 1. A 50 N force acts on a 10 kg body. Find the acceleration and the distance moved in 4 s from rest.

Solution:

1. $a = F/m = 50/10 =$ **$5\ m/s^2$**
2. $s = ½ \times 5 \times 4^2 =$ **40 m**

Example 2. A 20 g bullet leaves a 4 kg gun at 400 m/s. Find the recoil velocity of the gun.

Solution:

1. Momentum conservation: $4 \times v = 0.02 \times 400$
2. $v = 8/4 =$ **2 m/s**

Example 3. A 60 kg man stands in a lift accelerating up at 2 m/s^2. Find the floor reaction (g = 10).

Solution:

1. $R = m(g + a) = 60 \times 12 =$ **720 N**

Example 4. A projectile is thrown at 20 m/s at 45°. Find the range and maximum height (g = 10).

Solution:

1. $R = u^2 \sin 90°/g = 400/10 =$ **40 m**
2. $H = u^2 \sin^2 45°/2g = 400 \times 0.5/20 =$ **10 m**

6. Frequently Asked Facts

- Newton's first law defines force; the second law measures it.
- Action and reaction act on different bodies.
- Maximum range at 45°; then H = R/4.

7. Note (Confusing Facts)

- Unit of impulse N·s is the same as that of momentum kg·m/s.
- In free fall weight is not zero; the apparent weight is zero.
- At the top of a projectile's path the velocity is not zero but u cos θ.

Remember: One line: F = ma, p = mv, J = Ft = Δp. Assertion–Reason: (A) A gun recoils on firing. (R) Momentum is conserved. — Both true; R explains A.

20 Most Important One-Liner Facts — Laws of Motion

1. Law of inertia is?

— Newton's first law.

2. Measure of inertia?

— Mass.

3. Law for measuring force?

— Second law (F = ma).

4. Action–reaction law?

— Third law.

5. Formula of momentum?

— p = mv.

6. Impulse equals?

— Change in momentum.

7. Unit of impulse?

— N·s.

8. Rocket works on?

— Conservation of momentum.

9. Force added in D'Alembert's principle?

— Inertia force (−ma).

10. Formula of work?

— W = F s cos θ.

11. Formula of power?

— P = F·v.

12. 1 HP equals?

— 746 W.

13. Kinetic energy?

— ½mv².

14. Reaction in a lift accelerating up?

— m(g + a).

15. Apparent weight in free fall?

— Zero.

16. Angle for maximum range?

— 45°.

17. Range of projectile?

— $u^2 \sin 2\theta / g$.

18. Centripetal acceleration?

— v^2/r.

19. e for perfectly elastic collision?

— 1.

20. e for perfectly inelastic collision?

— 0.

Practice MCQs — Laws of Motion

Q1. Newton's first law gives the definition of:

(a) Force
(b) Momentum
(c) Work
(d) Energy

✔ **Answer: (a) Force**

Explanation: The first law defines force and inertia.

Q2. Impulse equals:

(a) Change in momentum
(b) Force × distance
(c) Mass × acceleration
(d) Kinetic energy

✔ **Answer: (a) Change in momentum**

Explanation: J = F·t = Δp.

Q3. Action and reaction act on:

(a) The same body
(b) Different bodies
(c) Sometimes same, sometimes different
(d) Moving bodies only

✔ **Answer: (b) Different bodies**

Explanation: That is why they do not cancel each other.

Q4. The range of a projectile is maximum when the angle of projection is:

(a) 30°
(b) 45°
(c) 60°
(d) 90°

✔ **Answer: (b) 45°**

Explanation: $\sin 2\theta = 1$ gives $\theta = 45°$.

Q5. Apparent weight of a man in a lift going down with acceleration a:

(a) $m(g + a)$
(b) $m(g - a)$
(c) mg
(d) Zero

✔ **Answer: (b) $m(g - a)$**

Explanation: $R = m(g - a)$.

Q6. The principle that converts a dynamic problem into static equilibrium:

(a) D'Alembert's
(b) Lami's
(c) Pascal's
(d) Archimedes'

✔ **Answer: (a) D'Alembert's**

Explanation: An inertia force $-ma$ is added.

Q7. 1 HP equals:

(a) 736 W
(b) 746 W
(c) 1000 W
(d) 550 W

✔ **Answer: (b) 746 W**

Explanation: 1 HP = 746 W (metric HP = 735.5 W).

Q8. Coefficient of restitution for a perfectly inelastic collision is:

(a) 0
(b) 0.5
(c) 1
(d) Infinity

✔ **Answer: (a) 0**

Explanation: Bodies stick together, $e = 0$.

Q9. A 5 kg body's velocity changes from 10 to 20 m/s in 2 s. The force is:

(a) 10 N
(b) 25 N
(c) 50 N
(d) 100 N

✔ **Answer: (b) 25 N**

Explanation: $a = 10/2 = 5\ m/s^2$, $F = 5 \times 5 = 25$ N.

Q10. Power is given by:

(a) F × s
(b) F × v
(c) m × v
(d) ½mv²

✔ **Answer: (b) F × v**

Explanation: P = W/t = F·s/t = F·v.

SSC JE / UPSSSC JE Previous Year Questions — Laws of Motion

Q1. Newton's second law gives the measurement of:

SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Force
(b) Inertia
(c) Energy
(d) Work

✔ **Answer: (a) Force**

Explanation: Force is measured by F = ma.

Q2. D'Alembert's principle is based on:

SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Newton's first law
(b) Newton's second law
(c) Newton's third law
(d) Energy conservation

✔ **Answer: (b) Newton's second law**

Explanation: F − ma = 0 is a form of the second law.

Q3. Unit of momentum is:

SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) kg·m/s
(b) kg·m/s²
(c) N/s
(d) J·s

✔ **Answer: (a) kg·m/s**

Explanation: p = mv.

Q4. At the highest point of its path, the velocity of a projectile is:

SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Zero
(b) u cos θ
(c) u sin θ
(d) u

✔ **Answer: (b) u cos θ**

Explanation: The vertical component is zero; the horizontal u cos θ remains.

Chapter 3: Friction

Friction – Basic Concept

When one body slides or tends to slide over another, a force opposing the motion develops between the contact surfaces; this is called **friction**. It always acts tangential to the surfaces and opposite to the (tendency of) motion.

1. Key Points

- **Static friction:** friction while the body is at rest; it is self-adjusting and rises up to the limiting value $F_s = \mu_s R$.
- **Limiting friction:** the maximum friction force just before motion starts.
- **Kinetic (dynamic) friction:** friction during motion; it is less than limiting friction. Order: static (limiting) > sliding > rolling friction.
- **Coefficient of friction:** $\mu = F/R$, where R is the normal reaction. It is dimensionless.
- **Angle of friction (φ):** the angle between the resultant reaction and the normal; $\tan \varphi = \mu$.
- **Angle of repose (α):** the maximum inclination of a plane at which a body just begins to slide under its own weight; $\alpha = \varphi$.
- **Laws of dry (Coulomb) friction:** (i) $F \propto R$; (ii) F is independent of contact area; (iii) F depends on the nature of surfaces; (iv) kinetic friction is nearly independent of speed at low speeds.
- **Types by lubrication:** dry, boundary (thin film) and fluid (viscous) friction.

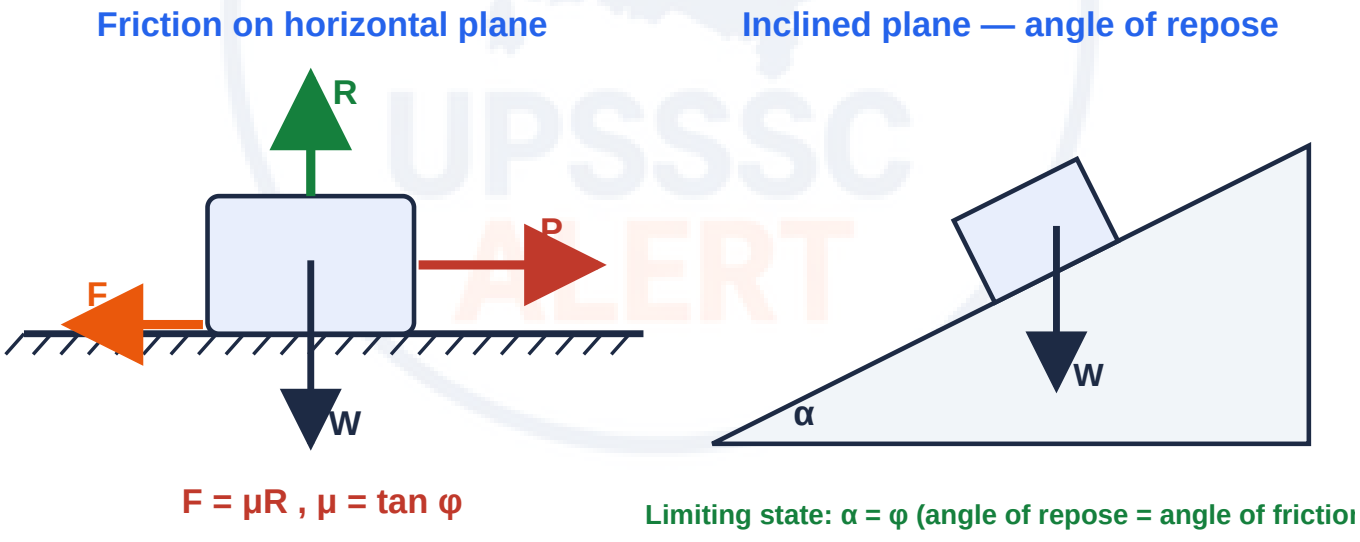


Fig 2.4: Force of friction and angle of repose on an inclined plane

2. Important Formulas & Facts

Quantity / Topic	Formula / Fact
Friction force	**$F = \mu R$**
Angle of friction	**$\tan \varphi = \mu$**
Angle of repose	**$\alpha = \varphi$**
Pull up the plane (parallel to plane)	**$P = W(\sin \alpha + \mu \cos \alpha)$**
Pull down the plane	**$P = W(\mu \cos \alpha - \sin \alpha)$**
Horizontal plane, pull at angle θ	**$P = \mu W / (\cos \theta + \mu \sin \theta)$**
Angle for least force	**$\theta = \varphi \rightarrow P_{min} = W \sin \varphi$**
Belt / rope friction	**$T_1/T_2 = e^{\mu\theta}$**

3. Detailed Explanation

- **Cause of friction:** interlocking of microscopic surface projections (asperities) and intermolecular adhesion.
- **Body on an inclined plane:** W sin α acts down the plane and friction μW cos α opposes it. If tan α ≤ μ, the body will not slide by itself.
- **Ladder problems:** taking normal reactions and friction at wall and floor, apply ΣFx = ΣFy = ΣM = 0.
- **Advantages and disadvantages:** walking, brakes, belt drives and the grip of nuts and bolts depend on friction; but it also causes energy loss, wear and heat. Lubrication and ball bearings reduce it.
- **Rolling friction:** the resistance due to deformation at contact during rolling; much smaller than sliding friction — hence wheels and bearings.

4. Comparison Table — Static vs Kinetic Friction

Basis	Static	Kinetic
State	At rest	In motion
Magnitude	0 to $\mu_s R$ (self-adjusting)	Nearly constant $\mu_k R$
Coefficient	μ_s (higher)	μ_k (lower)
Example	Car parked on a slope	Sliding box

5. Solved Numerical Problems

Example 1. A 200 N body rests on a horizontal plane, μ = 0.3. Find the horizontal force needed to move it.

Solution:

1. P = μW = 0.3 × 200 = **60 N**

Example 2. If $\mu = 0.5$, find the angle of friction and angle of repose.

Solution:

1. $\varphi = \tan^{-1} 0.5 =$ **26.57°**
2. Angle of repose $\alpha = \varphi =$ **26.57°**

Example 3. A 500 N body lies on a 30° incline, $\mu = 0.2$. Find the force parallel to the plane to move it up.

Solution:

1. $P = W(\sin 30° + \mu \cos 30°) = 500(0.5 + 0.2 \times 0.866)$
2. $P = 500 \times 0.673 =$ **336.6 N**

Example 4. A body is just on the point of sliding on a 25° incline. Find the coefficient of friction.

Solution:

1. $\mu = \tan 25° =$ **0.466**

6. Frequently Asked Facts

- Friction force does not depend on the area of contact.
- Angle of repose = angle of friction; $\mu = \tan \varphi$.
- Limiting friction > kinetic friction > rolling friction.

7. Note (Confusing Facts)

- Static friction is not always μR; μR is only its limiting (maximum) value.
- μ can exceed 1 (e.g. rubber on rubber).
- When pulling at an angle θ, the least force is needed when $\theta = \varphi$.

Remember: One line: $F = \mu R$, $\tan \varphi = \mu$, $\alpha = \varphi$. Assertion–Reason: (A) Moving a load on wheels is easier. (R) Rolling friction is less than sliding friction. — Both true; R explains A.

20 Most Important One-Liner Facts — Friction

1. Formula of friction force?

— $F = \mu R$.

2. Unit of coefficient of friction?

— Dimensionless.

3. Relation of φ and μ?

— $\tan \varphi = \mu$.

4. Angle of repose equals?

— Angle of friction.

5. Friction just before motion?

— Limiting friction.

6. Friction during motion?

— Kinetic friction.

7. Least friction?

— Rolling friction.

8. Does friction depend on area?

— No.

9. Direction of friction?

— Opposite to motion.

10. Self-adjusting friction?

— Static friction.

11. Effect of lubrication?

— Reduces friction.

12. Friction with thin lubricant film?

— Boundary friction.

13. Friction with thick film?

— Fluid (viscous) friction.

14. Force to pull up incline?

— $W(\sin \alpha + \mu \cos \alpha)$.

15. Angle of least pull?

— Angle of friction φ.

16. Belt tension ratio?

— $e^{\mu\theta}$.

17. Condition for no sliding?

— $\tan \alpha \leq \mu$.

18. Cause of friction?

— Interlocking of surface asperities.

19. Laws of dry friction by?

— Coulomb.

20. Brakes work on?

— Friction.

Practice MCQs — Friction

Q1. Friction force does not depend on:

(a) Normal reaction
(b) Nature of surfaces
(c) Area of contact
(d) Coefficient of friction

✔ **Answer: (c) Area of contact**

Explanation: Coulomb's law — independent of area.

Q2. Relation between angle of friction φ and μ:

(a) $\mu = \sin \varphi$
(b) $\mu = \cos \varphi$
(c) $\mu = \tan \varphi$
(d) $\mu = \cot \varphi$

✔ **Answer: (c) $\mu = \tan \varphi$**

Explanation: $\tan \varphi = F/R = \mu$.

Q3. The angle of repose is equal to:

(a) Angle of friction
(b) $90° - \varphi$
(c) 2φ
(d) $\varphi/2$

✔ **Answer: (a) Angle of friction**

Explanation: In the limiting state $\alpha = \varphi$.

Q4. The correct order is:

(a) Rolling > sliding > static
(b) Static > sliding > rolling
(c) Sliding > static > rolling
(d) All equal

✔ **Answer: (b) Static > sliding > rolling**

Explanation: Limiting/static friction is the greatest, rolling the least.

Q5. Weight 100 N, μ = 0.25 — horizontal force to move it:

(a) 25 N
(b) 40 N
(c) 75 N
(d) 400 N

✔ **Answer: (a) 25 N**

Explanation: F = 0.25 × 100 = 25 N.

Q6. The unit of coefficient of friction is:

(a) N
(b) N/m
(c) No unit
(d) N·m

✔ **Answer: (c) No unit**

Explanation: It is a ratio of two forces.

Q7. A body on an incline will not slide by itself if:

(a) tan α > μ
(b) tan α ≤ μ
(c) sin α > μ
(d) cos α < μ

✔ **Answer: (b) tan α ≤ μ**

Explanation: W sin α ≤ μW cos α gives tan α ≤ μ.

Q8. When pulling at an angle θ, the least force is needed when:

(a) θ = 0
(b) θ = 45°
(c) θ = φ
(d) θ = 90°

✔ **Answer: (c) θ = φ**

Explanation: P = μW/(cos θ + μ sin θ) is minimum at θ = φ.

Q9. Friction with a very thin lubricant film is called:

(a) Dry
(b) Boundary
(c) Viscous
(d) Rolling

✔ **Answer: (b) Boundary**

Explanation: Surfaces remain in partial contact.

Q10. If a body is just about to slide on a 30° incline, μ is:

(a) 0.5
(b) 0.577
(c) 0.866
(d) 1.732

✔ **Answer: (b) 0.577**

Explanation: μ = tan 30° = 0.577.

SSC JE / UPSSSC JE Previous Year Questions — Friction

Q1. The ratio of limiting friction to normal reaction is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Coefficient of friction
(b) Angle of friction
(c) Angle of repose
(d) Efficiency

✔ **Answer: (a) Coefficient of friction**

Explanation: $\mu = F/R$.

Q2. If the angle of friction is φ, the angle of repose is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) φ
(b) 2φ
(c) φ/2
(d) 90° − φ

✔ **Answer: (a) φ**

Explanation: $\alpha = \varphi$.

Q3. Kinetic friction compared to limiting friction is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) More
(b) Less
(c) Equal
(d) Infinite

✔ **Answer: (b) Less**

Explanation: Friction drops once motion starts.

Q4. According to Coulomb's laws, friction force is: SSC JE (Previous Year)

(a) Proportional to area
(b) Proportional to normal reaction
(c) Proportional to velocity
(d) Independent of load

✔ **Answer: (b) Proportional to normal reaction**

Explanation: $F \propto R$.

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